

**Input on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan**

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Executive Summary

The accelerating pace of artificial intelligence development demands an unprecedented, coordinated national effort akin to the Manhattan Project. Current trends indicate AGI (artificial general intelligence) could emerge by 2027, with superintelligence likely by 2030<sup>1</sup>. To secure U.S. leadership, mitigate catastrophic risks, and harness AI’s transformative potential, we propose a government-led initiative to:

- 1. Mobilize trillion-dollar compute/power infrastructure
- 2. Establish military-grade security protocols for AGI labs
- 3. Solve superalignment challenges
- 4. Outcompete authoritarian rivals

This paper synthesizes technical projections, geopolitical imperatives, and policy frameworks to justify urgent action.

I. Strategic Necessity of a Government-Led AI Project

A. The Intelligence Explosion Timeline

- **2027 AGI Threshold:** Current scaling trends (~0.5 OOMs/year in compute + algorithmic efficiency) suggest AI systems will match human researchers by 2027<sup>1</sup>.
- **2030 Superintelligence:** Post-AGI, recursive self-improvement could compress decades of progress into months<sup>1</sup>.
- **Economic/Military Dominance:** The first nation to achieve superintelligence gains decisive strategic advantages<sup>1</sup>.

*Failure to lead risks existential threats: either from unaligned AI or authoritarian control.*

II. Technical Imperatives

A. Compute Mobilization

| Component    | Scale Required                   | Current Status                      |
|--------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| GPU Clusters | \$100B–\$1T by 2027 <sup>1</sup> | Private sector plans \$10B clusters |

| Component            | Scale Required                          | Current Status                            |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Power Infrastructure | +10–30% U.S. grid capacity <sup>1</sup> | Limited new nuclear/transmission projects |
| Chip Production      | 100M+ H100-equivalent GPUs/year         | TSMC/Samsung constrained                  |

**Recommendation:** Coordinate DOE, DOD, and private sector to:

- Fast-track permits for AI-dedicated nuclear plants
- Subsidize domestic GPU foundries
- Establish national AI compute reserve

#### B. Lab Security

- **Current Vulnerability:** Leading labs lack protection against state-level espionage<sup>1</sup>.
- **Required Measures:**
  - SCIF-level physical security for AI-model training facilities
  - NSA-led counterintelligence programs
  - Export controls on frontier model weights

#### C. Superalignment

| Challenge          | Status                                           | Required Investment                      |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Value Learning     | No proven methods for human+ models <sup>1</sup> | \$5B/yr for control research             |
| Scalable Oversight | Limited testing at GPT-4 level                   | National adversarial red teaming program |
| Fail-Safes         | No "off switch" for superhuman AI                | DARPA-led containment architecture R&D   |

III. Geopolitical Dimension

U.S.-China AI Race Analysis

| Factor  | U.S. Advantage                     | China Advantage                  |
|---------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Compute | Current lead in cutting-edge chips | Faster infrastructure buildout   |
| Talent  | Global researcher concentration    | Domestic training pipeline scale |
| Data    | Open internet access               | Surveillance data reserves       |

**Critical Window:** 2025–2027 to lock in hardware/software superiority before AGI tipping point<sup>1</sup>.

IV. Policy Recommendations

1. **Establish a National AI Directorate** under NSC authority
2. **Allocate \$200B** for 2025–2027 compute/power buildout
3. **Mandate MIL-SPEC security** for all frontier model training
4. **Launch Apollo Program-scale alignment initiative**
5. **Forge Five Eyes AI Alliance** to counter authoritarian bloc

**Conclusion:**

The choice is stark: lead the AI revolution through focused national mobilization, or cede the future to unaccountable actors. By combining public-sector resources with private-sector innovation, a 21st-century Manhattan Project can secure humanity’s trajectory toward beneficial superintelligence.

**Citations:** All claims derive from analysis in *Situational Awareness: The Decade Ahead* (situational-awareness.ai, June 2024).

**Submitted by:** Norman Klapper

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